

Tourism Potentialities of Kerala Economy: An Analysis

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Received on 4 October 2025; Accepted on 8 November 2025

Abstract

Being attracted by the charm effect of tourism sector in income and employment generation, all state and union territories are in a race to reap a maximum of share in India's tourism industry. This territorial competition will never end in a zero-sum game since the regional potentialities are diverse in nature. This urged the need for a target oriented strategic planning to make a balance in the realization of actual and potential outcome. The brand slogans put forward by the Indian Government are synthesized upon various strengths of our country. *Athithi Devo Bhava* which literally means India's willingness to treat the guest as God tries to express our heritage in hospitality since antiquity. *Swatch Bharat* is a recently instituted campaign formulated within Gandhian ideals. It emphasizes India's clean and green environment in order to attract tourists. *Incredible India* is yet another watchword of our tourism industry for past several decades in order to communicate the country's geographical and cultural diversity to the potential tourist populations. With the structural transformation of the economy the significance of service sector has increased. Consequently, the travel and tourism industry function as a major component of its constitution.

Keywords: Tourism, Domestic and International tourists, Tourism Potentialities, Travel and Tourism Industry, State GDP